knowledge is valid as such, for their validity is to be established independently of their origin, unless, of course, like the *Mīmāṁsakas,* we hold that all cognitions produced from whatever source are valid as such. We are again confusing sources of knowledge and criteria of their truth or falsity. What is contended is not that the word of a reliable person is true as such, but that we rightly regard it as true until the contrary is established quite in the same manner as we regard our perceptions. Moreover, this objection of the opponent is not against all testimony, but only against a particular testimony, a fact to which all the orthodox Indian philosophers would readily agree. The conclusion is unavoidable, therefore, that testimony is as much a valid source of knowledge as perception or inference. There is thus no reason for not including authority among the valid sources of knowledge.

Granting testimony as an independent source of knowledge, the question may now be asked as to wherein the validity of testimony actually lies. The answer is that it lies in the trustworthiness of the speaker and that this trustworthiness is always as verifiable as that of any other means of knowledge, like signs on the road or the words of a doctor. The *Nyāya-sūtra* continues: "The Trustworthiness of the Word (of the Veda) is based upon the trustworthiness of the reliable (veracious) expositor, just like the trustworthiness of Incantations and of Medical Scriptures."[8] The *Bhāṣya* again raises the question "In what does the trustworthiness of the Medical Scriptures consist?" and the answer given is that it consists in verification. "It consists in the fact that, when the Medical Scriptures declare that 'by doing this and this one obtains what he desires, and by avoiding this and this he escapes from what is undesirable'—and a person acts accordingly,—*the result turns out to be exactly as asserted;* and this shows that the said Scriptures are *true,* not *wrong* in what they assert."[9] What is important for us, however, is to note that it is on the basis of verifiability alone that the Vedas are believed to be reliable and hence authoritative by the orthodox systems. It is quite another matter, if an opponent regards the same as unreliable as a result of unverifiability, for the ground of belief or disbelief in both cases would be the same.

It is necessary to close the discussion with a final reiteration. In Indian philosophical discussion, the term *pramāṇa* is used in the sense of a psychological cause of knowledge, but it is a logical concept also inasmuch as it limits the validity of such causes to only a few of the many possible causes of knowledge; for instance, rumor or hearsay is not regarded as a valid source of knowledge. Translated into English, *pramāṇa* is rendered as "valid means of